

Federal Reserve

Federal Reserve reappoints regional chiefs in move that allays fears of challenge by Trump allies

Decision eases concerns that central bankers aligned with the US president would block them remaining in their roles



The regional Fed presidents have been the most hawkish voices on the rate-setting Federal Open Market Committee © AFP/Getty Images

Claire Jones in Washington

Published DEC 11 2025

The Federal Reserve has reappointed its regional bosses earlier than anticipated, allaying concerns that Donald Trump's allies on the central bank's board could have sought to block them remaining in their roles.

The Fed's board said on Thursday it had backed a decision to reappoint the 11 regional presidents who intend to remain in their roles. The vote, which occurs every five years, was scheduled to take place before the end of February.

While the process has rarely attracted much attention in the past, the president's hostility towards the [Fed](#) had raised concerns that some of the heads of the 12 regional banks that make up its regional network could see their terms blocked.

The regional Fed presidents have been the most hawkish voices on the rate-setting Federal Open Market Committee, warning of the dangers of rising [inflation](#) amid calls from Trump and his economic advisers for the central bank to engage in aggressive cuts to borrowing costs.

Two of them — Chicago Fed head Austan Goolsbee and his Kansas City counterpart Jeffrey Schmid — dissented from Wednesday's decision to [cut US borrowing costs](#) by a quarter point to between 3.5 and 3.75 per cent.

Another four signalled their displeasure with the decision through so-called dot plots of projections that indicated they thought borrowing costs should have remained at the range between 3.75 and 4 per cent set in October.

Two of those four were likely to have been Cleveland Fed head Beth Hammack and Dallas Fed president Lorie Logan — both of whom will have a vote on monetary policy from January, analysts said.

US Treasury secretary Scott Bessent, who has been running the process to appoint the next Fed chair, has been among the most vocal critics of the power held by the regional presidents.

Earlier this week, Bessent signalled the administration would try to force through a change that would require all new regional Fed presidents to live in the district they served for three years before they took on the role.

While all 12 participate in FOMC meetings and deliver their own quarterly dot-plot forecasts of what happens next to [interest rates](#), only the New York chief has a permanent vote on the panel. Of the remaining 11, four receive voting seats that change each year.

The seven members of the Fed's board of governors also vote at each meeting.

The vote to reappoint the regional Fed heads received unanimous support from the board of governors, which includes Trump ally Stephen Miran, along with Christopher Waller and Michelle Bowman, both of whom were appointed during Trump's first term.

Unlike governors, regional Fed heads do not require a presidential nomination followed by Senate approval. The process of appointing them is handled by the board of directors of each regional Fed.

The previous vote to reappoint the regional Fed presidents and their deputies took place in January 2021 — though earlier reappointments have happened in the year before a decision needed to be finalised.

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